

Tuan (Todd) Cao

Marketing & Consumer Behaviour Scholar | Digital Marketing & Artificial Intelligence
| Sustainable Marketing | Marketing Ethics

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Research Expertise

Research Areas: Sustainable Marketing and Consumer Behaviour; Consumer Psychographics and Individual Differences; Artificial Intelligence and Human-AI Interaction; Consumer Well-Being; Digital Marketing and Digital Transformation; AI-Enabled Decision-Making; Digital Ethics and Responsible Technology.

Academic Appointments

Griffith University, Australia — Sessional Academic

2025–Present

- Contribute to research projects in Marketing, Consumer Behaviour, Artificial Intelligence, and emerging digital technologies.
- Conduct research design, survey development, data collection, and quantitative and qualitative data analysis for international research projects.
- Contribute to manuscript development, research ethics applications, and responses to reviewers for peer-reviewed journal publications.
- Collaborate with academic researchers on research design, advanced data analysis, project coordination, and publication development.

Hoa Sen University, Vietnam — Program Director & Lecturer in Marketing

2025–Present

- Teach Research in Marketing, Marketing and Business Fundamentals, Corporate Communications, Crisis Management, and Introduction to Public Relations.
- Lead programme development, curriculum review, course design, academic quality assurance, and accreditation activities.
- Develop programme content and accreditation evidence for AUN-QA review and represent the programme during meetings and interviews with accreditation panels.
- Lead programme coordination, faculty planning, student engagement, and university–industry collaboration.

Van Lang University, Vietnam — Lecturer in Marketing

2023–2024

- Taught undergraduate courses in Principles of Marketing, Consumer Behaviour, and Business Analytics.

Nguyen Tat Thanh University, Vietnam — Lecturer in Management

2020–2023

- Taught undergraduate courses in E-Commerce, Strategic Marketing, and International Business.

Education

PhD in Management (Marketing)

University of Southern Queensland, Australia

2026

PhD in Business Administration

Open University, Vietnam

Conferral pending

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

Open University, Vietnam

2017–2019

Current Research Programme

Digital Marketing, Artificial Intelligence, and Human–AI Interaction Examine how consumers respond to Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI), AI-generated recommendations, synthetic endorsers, AI-mediated services, and emerging forms of human–AI interaction in digital markets.

Sustainable Marketing, Consumption, and Consumer Well-Being Investigate sustainable consumer behaviour, sustainability communication, green-rinsing, and the psychological and digital mechanisms that shape sustainable decision-making and consumer well-being.

Consumer Psychographics and Individual Differences Study how values, self-concept, perceptions, and other individual differences shape consumer responses to artificial intelligence, digital technologies, brands, and consumption experiences.

Digital Ethics and Responsible Technology Explore the ethical and societal implications of AI-enabled decision-making, synthetic media, automated persuasion, and technology-mediated consumption, with particular attention to trust, responsibility, and consumer welfare.

Selected Peer-Reviewed Journal Publications

Accepted | ABDC A* | AJG-3

Mai, N., **Cao, T. T.***, & Yunen, Z. (Forthcoming). How hotels communicate sustainability goal revisions: The role of perceived green-rinsing, influencer type, and sustainability solutions. *Journal of Sustainable Tourism*.

Published | ABDC A | AJG-3

Cao, T. T.*, Prentice, C., Wang, Q., & Nguyen, S. (2025). Financial self-discrepancy, consumer well-being, and luxury preferences: The moderating effect of access-based luxury formats. *Psychology & Marketing*, 43, 357–373. doi.org/10.1002/mar.70057

Published | ABDC A | AJG-2

Cao, T. T., Prentice, C., Wang, Q., & Nguyen, H. S.* (2026). Conflicted by faith, drawn to pleasure: How religious self-discrepancy shapes product choices. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, 50(2), e70202. doi.org/10.1111/ijcs.70202

Published | ABDC A | AJG-2

Cao, T. T.*, Prentice, C., Wang, Q., & Nguyen, H. S. (2025). Compensatory consumption: A review and research agenda using the theory-context-characteristics-methodology framework. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, 49(5), e70112. doi.org/10.1111/ijcs.70112

Published | ABDC A | AJG-2

Cao, T. T., Yunen, Z., & Tuan, N.* (2026). When Generative Artificial Intelligence becomes a counsellor: How employee evaluations shape engagement and organizational attractiveness. *Journal of Enterprise Information Management*. doi.org/10.1108/JEIM-02-2026-0238

Accepted | ABDC A | AJG-2

Tuan, N., & **Cao, T. T.*** (Forthcoming). Working with GenAI: How human-centered mindset and GenAI understanding drive employee autonomy and competence. *Journal of Enterprise Information Management*.

Accepted | ABDC A | AJG-2

Cao, T. T., Mai, N., Tuan, N.*, Malik, A., & Anjali, T. (Forthcoming). AI leadership: Employee perceptions and pathways to compliance. *The Service Industries Journal*.

Published | ABDC B | AJG-1

Cao, T. T., & Tuan, N.* (2026). Understanding consumer purchase intention toward Zero-Click GenAI-generated recommendations: Evidence from structural equation modeling and machine learning. *Journal of Internet*

Other Peer-Reviewed Journal Publications

Published | Peer-Reviewed Journal

Cao, T. T.* (2025). Self-discrepancy and gambling retention: A conceptual model of motivational and moral pathways. *Strategic Business Research*, 1(1), 100001. doi.org/10.1016/j.sbr.2025.100001

Published | Peer-Reviewed Journal

Cao, T. T., & Nguyen, S.* (2024). Navigating dual identities: How bicultural consumers leverage luxury consumption to cope with perceived discrimination and enhance well-being. *Journal of Development and Integration*, 85, 106–116. doi.org/10.61602/jdi.2025.85.12

Published | Peer-Reviewed Journal

Ha, N. M., & **Cao, T. T.*** (2019). Constructing athlete identification and the effectiveness of athlete endorsement on customer's purchase intention. *Journal of Distribution Science*, 17(8). doi.org/10.15722/jds.17.8.201908.87

* Corresponding author

Manuscripts Under Review

Second-Round Revision | ABDC A* | AJG-3

Yunen, Z., **Cao, T. T.***, & Mai, N. (2025). The right endorser for the right stay: How human and AI endorsers differ across privacy levels and service modes in accommodation booking intention. *International Journal of Hospitality Management*.

Under Review | ABDC A* | AJG-3

Cao, T. T.*, Nguyen, M., & Nham, T. P. (2026). When hotels revise sustainability goals: A paradox theory perspective on perceived green-rinsing and consumer evaluation. *Journal of Sustainable Tourism*.

Under Review | ABDC A* | AJG-4

Cao, T. T.*, Cheah, I., & Liu, X. (2026). AI-curated sustainable hotel hopping: A push-pull-mooring perspective on travelers' delegation decisions. *Journal of Travel Research*.

Under Review | FT50 | ABDC A*

Yunen, Z., Mai, N., & **Cao, T. T.*** (2026). When synthetic endorsers are morally acceptable: Context-dependent consumer responses to AI-generated synthetic endorsers. *Journal of Consumer Psychology*.

Additional manuscripts are currently under peer review in sustainability, tourism, artificial intelligence, and consumer research, including submissions to

Book Chapters

Accepted

Nguyen, S., Phan, H., **Cao, T. T.**, Nguyen, M., & Zhang, Y. (Forthcoming). The evolution of AI in marketing. In *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.

Accepted

Phan, H. N. Q., Nguyen, S., **Cao, T. T.**, Nguyen, M., & Zhang, Y. (Forthcoming). GenAI in marketing. In *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.

Accepted

Phan, H., Nguyen, S., **Cao, T. T.**, Nguyen, M., & Zhang, Y. (Forthcoming). Synthetic media and AI influencers. In *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.

Accepted

Phan, H., Do, T., **Cao, T. T.**, Nguyen, M., & Zhang, Y. (Forthcoming). Conversational AI and customer interaction. In *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.

Accepted

Do, T., Phan, H., **Cao, T. T.**, Nguyen, M., & Zhang, Y. (Forthcoming). AI in customer experience and journeys. In *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.

Accepted

Phan, H., Do, T., **Cao, T. T.**, Nguyen, M., & Zhang, Y. (Forthcoming). AI-to-AI interactions in marketing. In *AI in Marketing: From Augmented Intelligence to Autonomous Markets*. Springer Nature.

Conference Presentations

21st International Forum on Knowledge Asset Dynamics (IFKAD), Hungary

2026

Cao, T. T., Ashish, M., & Mai, N. Employee evaluations of AI-generated leaders: A mixed-methods analysis of uncanniness, transparency, and employee outcomes.

Research Funding and Competitive Grant Experience

National Foundation for Science and Technology Development (NAFOSTED), Vietnam

2026

- **Role: Key Research Member** on a national competitive research proposal recommended for funding.
- Contributed to research design, methodological development, and proposal preparation.
- Total proposed funding: VND 3 billion.

Ministry of Education and Training Research Grant (B2024-MBS-09), Vietnam

2024

- **Role: Key Research Member** on a successfully completed government-funded research project.
- Contributed to research development, data analysis, and project outputs.
- Grant value: approximately USD 20,000.

Teaching Expertise and Supervision

- Consumer Behaviour; Digital Marketing; Sustainable Marketing; Marketing Ethics; Marketing Strategy; International Marketing; Branding; Marketing Research; Business Analytics; Artificial Intelligence in Marketing; Digital Business and E-Commerce; Corporate Communication.
- Currently supervise 15 Bachelor's thesis students and 9 Master's by Research students.
- More than five years of university teaching experience in Marketing, Consumer Behaviour, Digital Marketing, Marketing Research, Business Analytics, Digital Business, and Corporate Communication.
- Achieved an average student evaluation score of 4.8/5 at Hoa Sen University.
- Redesigned 10 undergraduate courses using student-centred, technology-enhanced, and applied learning approaches.
- Integrate artificial intelligence, digital technologies, data analytics, and current industry cases into marketing teaching and assessment.
- Connect classroom learning with practice through company visits, practitioner sessions, live cases, and industry partnerships.
- Delivered university teaching and professional training to more than 5,000 learners from diverse academic and professional backgrounds.
- Trained and mentored more than 30 teachers in teaching practice, classroom delivery, and student engagement.
- Mentored more than 200 students who achieved IELTS scores of 7.0 or above.
- Received institutional recognition for teaching excellence across multiple consecutive years.

Industry and Professional Experience

NIS International School, Vietnam — Brand Manager

2016–2020

- Managed campus operations and coordinated cross-functional teams.
- Increased student enrolment by approximately 10% annually from 2017 to 2020.
- Led brand communication and stakeholder engagement strategies.
- Developed partnerships with community organisations, media, and external stakeholders.

Advanced Research Methods and Data Analytics

Research Designs: Mixed-methods research; between-subjects experiments; cross-sectional research; factorial experiments; difference-in-differences designs; qualitative interviews; systematic literature reviews.

Statistical and Quantitative Methods: Structural Equation Modelling (SEM); PLS-SEM; regression modelling; quantitative survey analysis, difference-in-differences analysis; .

Machine Learning and Computational Methods: Random Forest; Elastic Net; XGBoost; SHAP; Bayesian Networks; Grow-Shrink and Hill-Climbing algorithms; Natural Language Processing (NLP); text clustering; consumer archetype identification.

Software and Digital Tools: R; RStudio; SPSS; LaTeX; Quarto; GitHub.

Peer-Review Service

Serve on the Editorial Board of the Strategic Business Research Journal and conduct peer review for internationally refereed journals across Marketing, Management, Information Systems, and Tourism and Hospitality.

Editorial Board: *Strategic Business Research*.

Marketing: Psychology & Marketing; International Journal of Consumer Studies; Frontiers in Psychology; Strategic Business Research.

Management and Information Systems: Journal of Enterprise Information Management; Journal of Internet Commerce; Employee Relations.

Tourism and Hospitality: Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management.

Awards, Scholarships and Academic Recognition

Full PhD Scholarship and Stipend, University of Southern Queensland, Australia

2024–2026

Approximate value: USD 123,000.

Valedictorian, Master's Programme, Open University, Vietnam

2019

Graduated with the highest GPA and highest Master's thesis defence score in the programme.

Dedicated Teacher Award

2019–2021

Awarded for three consecutive years in recognition of teaching excellence and student engagement.

Most Excellent Teacher Award

2018

International Accreditation Recognition

University representative for FIBAA accreditation and quality assurance activities.

Full Master's Scholarship, Open University, Vietnam

2017–2019

Approximate value: USD 6,000.

Languages

English: Full professional proficiency; IELTS Academic overall score: 8.0.

Vietnamese: Native proficiency.

Academic Referees

Professor Catherine Prentice

Head of Marketing Discipline
University of Southern Queensland, Australia
Catherine.Prentice@unisq.edu.au 

Dr Jenny (Qingxia) Wang

Senior Lecturer
University of Southern Queensland, Australia
Jenny.Wang2@unisq.edu.au 

Dr Mai Nguyen

Insight Lab Co-Director
Griffith Business School, Griffith University, Australia
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